

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in regular session on Monday, August 4, 2025 at 6:00 p.m. in the commissioners' conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Thomas S. Hester, Jr., Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia L. Perry.

Absent: Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Kelly H. Grissom.

Commissioner Charisse Fain gave the invocation.

Before the meeting began, County Manager C. Renee Perry introduced Ms. Dywanda Pettaway as the new Clerk to the Board/Executive Assistant. It was noted that she will be sworn in on October 1 and officially appointed by the board during its October regular meeting. She will replace Kelly Grissom, who is retiring October 1. Mr. Willie Kearney was also introduced as the new Emergency Management Specialist.

Mr. Frankie Nobles, Vance County Employee Engagement Team Chair, was first on the agenda to recognize the new employee of the month. He noted that employees are nominated by their peers, and this month's recognition goes to Cathy Hope with the Finance Office. Her peers noted that she is a team player, has a pleasant personality, and is always willing to help others in any way possible. Ms. Hope will receive a monetary gift and a designated parking space for the month. She was presented with a plaque of appreciation, and the board congratulated her on receiving this recognition.

Public comments were heard next. Mr. Brandon Link, Vance County Fire Association President, informed the board that a majority of the fire association voted in support of keeping the Vance Rescue Squad as is. Wes Langston, Curtis Brame, and Bryan Yount also spoke in support of keeping the rescue squad as is.

Mr. Arnold Pharr stated that he is the owner of Environmental Waste and Debris Removal and is certified in erosion settlement and stormwater infrastructure inspections. He stated that he

has noticed a lot of illegal dumping throughout the county as well as trash and sediment build up in creeks and streams.

Ms. Angie Ryan urged the board to take action on fire study results. She stated that the study recommends merging the operations of the Vance Rescue Squad with the Vance County Fire Department. She noted that the team would be stronger if they all worked together.

Tax Administrator Jennifer Williams was next on the agenda and presented the following untimely exemption applications for approval. She stated that if the applications had been submitted by the deadline, she would have approved them at the staff level.

Untimely Exemptions

Name	Exemption Requested	Tax Administrator’s Recommendation
AloMae Hicks 1075 Keeton Road PIN 0310 02006	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Benjamin H. Flanagan 81 White Deer Lane PIN 0326A01021	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Curtis Frank Terry 127 S. Elizabeth Street PIN 0085 10005	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Donald M. Ramsey 704 Murphy Road PIN 0212 02032	Disabled Veteran Exemption	Approve Application
Dorothy K. Matthews 722 Boddie Street PIN 0068 04009	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Frieda L. Murphy 82 Wrenn Road PIN 0431 02010	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Jocelyne Ruehling 42 Squirrel Hollow PIN 0458A03006	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Judy Evelyn Loving 164 Franklin Road PIN 0536 03035	Disabled Veteran Exemption	Approve Application
Mary H. Terry 2785 Burnside Road PIN 0362 04006	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Ruth O. Allen 421 Sunnyview Road PIN 0214C02006	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Sandra Hubbard 59 E. Main Street PIN 0479 05008	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Sharon W. Jones 915 Nelson Street PIN 0011 03023	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Akisha Baskerville 4782 Satterwhite Point Road PIN 0591 01008	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application

Mr. Chris Whittemore, Mecklenburg, VA, who was the next scheduled appointment, did not show for the meeting.

City Manager Hassan Kingsberry appeared before the board to request the continuance of the joint agreement between the city and county related to code inspections and building permits. The current agreement expires August 31. He stated that a majority of the city council supports this request.

Following brief discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to approve a 30-day extension and allow staff to draft an agreement for both parties to approve beyond that point. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain and unanimously approved.

Water District Board

Chair Carolyn Faines called the Water District Board to order. The June 2025 monthly operations report was presented to the board for information. Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

Finance Director's Report

Audit Committee Report. Finance Director Stephanie Williams stated that the Audit Committee met on July 30 to review the upcoming audit process with the new audit team. The committee requested to be included in the Engagement Organizer used by the auditors as well as emails between staff and the auditors. Since the audit committee is an advisory committee, she stated that she and the county manager do not support this request because of the sensitive nature of some of the information. Also, the audit committee charter states that the committee should oversee the appointment of the independent auditor but does not give the committee authority to oversee the day-to-day work of staff.

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt stated that the committee has concerns and feels that transparency is key for security purposes. He noted that the information requested is public information apart from sensitive material, which can be redacted. He stated that the goal of the committee is to support the county and make sure things are completed on time. Chair Carolyn Faines stated that county staff do not report to the audit committee regardless of whether the information is public record or not. Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. agreed.

County Manager C. Renee Perry provided the following statement: *The audit committee is appointed to serve the board of county commissioners in an advisory capacity. The committee*

does not have authority over county operations or personnel, and no county staff members report to the audit committee. All staff are under the direction and supervision of the county manager. Therefore, any requests for information, documentation, or interaction with staff should be directed through the county manager's office and the budget and finance director.

To maintain professional boundaries and preserve the integrity of the audit process, the following guidelines should also be observed:

- Audit Committee members should not be included in internal staff email communications with the county's external auditors.*
- They should not be granted access to the county's audit organizer or other auditor workspaces or platforms that are used by staff and the audit firm for managing the audit process.*

Furthermore, I recommend that the board of county commissioners review the current audit committee charter to ensure it accurately reflects the committee's intended purpose and responsibilities. A clear understanding of the committee's advisory role - particularly as it relates to oversight of the external audit, review of financial reports, and support of financial accountability - will prevent confusion and reinforce productive collaboration between the committee, staff, and auditors.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. to support the county manager's recommendation. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr.

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt stated that this is a violation of public records law by not allowing the committee access to this information. County Attorney Jonathan S. Care responded that this is not an accurate statement of the law. Commissioner Valencia L. Perry stated that she did not want any information that she is not allowed to have.

Vote on the motion to support the county manager's recommendation was ayes – five (5); noes – one (1), with the dissenting vote being cast by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt.

Budget Amendments #1 - #9. Ms. Williams presented Budget Amendments #1 - #9 for approval. She noted that Budget Amendments #7 and #8 would be addressed under the county manager's report.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve Budget Amendment #1 as presented:

Budget Amendment #1
FY 2025-2026
Detention Center

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	214,530
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$214,530

Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Capital Outlay	10-520-500074	214,530
Total		\$214,530

Purpose: Approval to carryover funds for purchase of vans for Detention Center. They are being upfitted.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
August 4, 2025

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Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, to approve Budget Amendment #2 as presented:

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Budget Amendment #2
FY 2025-2026
Animal Services

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	14,092
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$14,092

Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Community Partnership for Pets	10-599-500211	14,092
Total		\$14,092

Purpose: Transfer the balance of unused grant funding from prior fiscal year.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
August 4, 2025

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Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt requested that Budget Amendment #3 be broken down by project. Ms. Williams responded that this can be done.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote unanimous, to approve Budget Amendment #3 contingent upon breakdown by project.

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Budget Amendment #3 (with breakdown)
FY 2025-2026
Detention Center; EMS; 911

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	61-399-439900	5,000,000
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$5,000,000
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Tower Project	61-660-500493	199,250
EMS Substation Project	61-660-500494	68,200
EMS/Fire Main Station Project	61-660-500495	110,450
Detention Center Project	61-660-500496	4,622,100
Total		\$5,000,000

Purpose: Approval for Existing Detention Renovations, New Detention Construction Design Build Project, EMS/Tower Land Purchasing, Surveying and Soil Testing.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
August 4, 2025

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Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to approve Budget Amendment #4 as presented. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and unanimously approved.

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Budget Amendment #4
FY 2025-2026
Various Departments

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	46,384.74
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$46,384.74
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Maintenance Equipment	10-530-500016	11,346.59
Maintenance Equipment	10-531-500016	14,275.15
Maintenance Equipment	10-621-500016	5,190.75
Maintenance Equipment	10-510-500016	10,381.50
Maintenance Equipment	10-599-500016	5,190.75
Total		\$46,384.74

Purpose: Approval to carryover funds for replacement and service for TMDA radios. Previously authorized at the December 2, 2024 meeting. Items not received due to the vendor backlog.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
August 4, 2025

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Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve Budget Amendment #5 as presented:

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Budget Amendment #5
FY 2025-2026
4-H; Cooperative Extension; Farmers Market

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	20,319.13
BSNC Grant	10-333-433315	5,000
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$25,319.13

Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
BSNC Grant	10-605-500104	5,000
TNHF	10-605-500100	7,962.13
NCIDEA	10-605-500110	2,573
Triangle North HealthCare (Double Bucks)	10-622-500090	9,784
Total		\$25,319.13

Purpose: Request Approval for acceptance of new BSNC Grant and to transfer the balance of unused grants from prior fiscal year.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
August 4, 2025

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Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve Budget Amendment #6 as presented:

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Budget Amendment #6
FY 2025-2026
DSS

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	9,987.79
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		9,987.79

Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
VIP Support Services for Blind	10-610-500120	390.51

Donations for Foster Children	10-613-500061	9,597.28
Total		\$ 9,987.79

Purpose: Transfer the balance of unused donations from prior fiscal year.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
 August 4, 2025

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 Motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve Budget Amendment #9 as presented.

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Budget Amendment #9
FY 2025-2026
Head Start

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	150,000
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$150,000

Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Capital Project	10-696-500075	150,000
Total		\$150,000

Purpose: Approval to budget for the purchase and installation of new doors at Head Start.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
 August 4, 2025

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Assistant County Manager’s Report

Public Safety Committee Report. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones noted that during the June 16 budget work session, the board agreed to extend the rescue squad contract for 90 days (through September 30, 2025) to allow the county fire department time to acquire its own equipment. On July 29, the Public Safety Committee met jointly with the Vance County Fire Commission to discuss this matter and a possible merger of the rescue squad with the county fire department. Committee Recommendation: To continue as originally agreed to fund the Vance Rescue Squad through September 30, 2025.

County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that there is misinformation in the community that the county is ending the rescue squad. She noted that the Vance Rescue Squad is a private, non-profit organization, and the county does not have any authority to end its operation. The county

can; however, end or reduce its funding to the rescue squad. Also, the Vance Rescue Squad is not EMS (ambulance). Vance County EMS is a county department.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. to formally terminate the county's funding and contract with the Vance Rescue Squad effective September 30, 2025. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr.

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt stated that there was not a recommendation from the committee on this matter. Secondly, the rescue squad is a part of the county's emergency plan. If they are eliminated, the plan will need to be updated, which will take time.

Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. stated that this matter has been discussed by the board several times, and the fire chief has stated that the county fire department can take over rescue duties. He called for the question.

Commissioner Valencia L. Perry stated that we need to slow down this process.

Chair Faines stated that the fire study recommends merging or increasing collaboration between the Vance County Fire Department and the Vance Rescue Squad. During the committee meeting, Vance Rescue Squad and Fire Commission member Doyle Carpunky commented that rescue squad employees/volunteers would not go to work for the fire department.

Following further discussion, the vote to formally terminate the county's funding and contract with the Vance Rescue Squad effective September 30, 2025 was ayes – four (4); noes – two (2), with the dissenting votes being cast by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and Commissioner Valencia L. Perry.

County Manager C. Renee Perry provided the following statement: *As county manager, I want to take this opportunity to publicly reaffirm the unwavering support of Vance County leadership for our public safety personnel and all county staff members who serve our community with professionalism, dedication, and integrity. Our staff are the backbone of county government providing essential services, responding to emergencies, supporting public health, maintaining infrastructure, ensuring fiscal responsibility, and upholding the day-to-day operations that keep our county running. We recognize the challenges they face and the sacrifices they make, often without recognition, to serve the residents here in Vance County. County leadership places its full trust in the expertise, judgement, and ethical standards of our staff. We are proud of their work and remain committed to providing them with a safe, respectful, and supportive work environment. We will continue to stand behind our staff, advocate for well-being, and ensure*

they are empowered to perform their duties with confidence and clarity. I appreciate all of our county staff. Thank you.

Jail Inspection Report. Mr. Jones noted that the State conducted its periodic jail inspection in June 2025. Although the Sheriff is responsible for overseeing the jail, it is necessary for the commissioners to receive the jail inspection report and be aware of potential budget items. Recommendation: Act to receive the report as information.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., vote unanimous, to receive the jail inspection report as presented.

Award of Service Weapon and Badge. Mr. Jones stated that Sheriff Curtis Brame has requested the award of the service weapon and badge to Captain Durwood Campbell following his retirement August 1, 2025. He has served Vance County for approximately 30 years. As per county policy, he is eligible to receive his service weapon and badge. Recommendation: Award service weapon and badge to retired Captain Durwood Campbell, according to county policy.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt to award the service weapon and badge to retired Captain Durwood Campbell as requested. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr. and unanimously approved.

County Manager's Report

Williams Montgomery Park Funding. County Manager C. Renee Perry noted that at the April 2025 work session, Recreation Director Kendrick Vann discussed a PARTF grant that was awarded to the Henderson-Vance Recreation Department to complete a project at Williams Montgomery Park. The grant was awarded in 2022 but due to COVID, the project was put on hold until recently. The total project cost is \$1.8M with a shortfall/match of \$1.1M. The joint city/county agreement is split 55% city and 45% county for operations and capital projects. At the time of the work session in April, the city was seeking the 45% shortfall of an estimated \$495,000 from the county. With updated cost projections, the shortfall is now \$684,982. The board gave staff direction to check our financial health to determine if it is feasible. Ms. Perry stated that she did not include the shortfall in the FY26 budget and does not recommend a fund balance appropriation for this. The project is underway with project completion in January 2026. She noted that she spoke with Mr. Vann and advised him that all future grants that require a match must have board support before an application process is even considered. Recommendation: Deny the county match of \$684,982 from fund balance.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt to deny the county match of \$684,982 from fund balance and deny Budget Amendment #7 as presented. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain and unanimously approved.

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Budget Amendment #7 (DENIED)
FY 2025-2026
City of Henderson

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance Appropriated	10-399-439900	684,981.90
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$684,981.90

Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Capital Projects	10-600-500214	684,981.90
Total		\$684,981.90

Purpose: Approval to pay Vance County’s portion of City of Henderson Williams Montgomery Project (splash park).

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
August 4, 2025

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Opioid Settlement Funds Annual Meeting Date. Ms. Perry noted that each county in North Carolina is required by the executed Memorandum of Agreement to hold an annual meeting, specifically with its municipalities, to explain the MOA, review monies being received, and go over the approved uses of the funds. Recommendation: Approve an informational meeting for September 16, 2025 at 4:00 p.m. This will replace the work session for the month of September.

Motion was made by Commissioner Charisse Fain to schedule the Opioid Settlement Funds Annual Meeting for Tuesday, September 16, 2025 at 4:00 p.m. This motion was seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt and unanimously approved.

Employee Appreciation Event. Ms. Perry requested approval to close county offices from 1:30 p.m. to 5:00 p.m. on Friday, October 10, 2025. Employees will enjoy food, games, line dancing, and more at Aycock Recreation Center.

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote unanimous, to close county offices from 1:30 p.m. to 5:00 p.m. on October 10, 2025 for the employee appreciation event.

401k Match	10-518-500009	3,250
Supplies, Materials, Other Fringes	10-518-500033	6,500
Total		\$103,288

Purpose: Approval to budget for an SRO position at Vance Charter School.

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
August 4, 2025

Industrial Park Shell Building. Ms. Perry asked for the board's interest in pursuing the construction of a new shell building within the county's portion of the industrial park. This project would be modeled after the successful shell building developed in the Henderson-Vance Industrial Park, which has proven to be a valuable asset in our economic development efforts. She stated that we can consider using funds that are owed back to the county from the loan issued to the Henderson-Vance Industrial Park as a potential funding source. As we continue with other needed capital projects (new construction of detention center, current detention center repairs, EMS Main, EMS Substation, etc.) there is a need for additional tax base to reduce the need for large tax increases. At this time, we would only begin site development and planning activities. All procurement of engineering, architectural, and related professional services would follow applicable General Statutes and county procurement policies. Recommendation: Approve/Deny staff moving forward with research and site development and planning activities only.

The board was receptive to this idea and motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., to authorize staff to move forward with research in site development and planning activities only. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and unanimously approved.

City of Henderson Communications Tower Funding. Ms. Perry noted that at the April 2025 work session, Henderson City Manager Hassan Kingsberry and Assistant City Manager Paylor Spruill discussed the proposed emergency communications tower located at the city's North Henderson ballfield park and requested cost sharing. It was mentioned that Duke Energy may co-locate and cover direct expenses above the grant as well as an inquiry out to Verizon. The city has been notified that Duke Power will not be contributing to any of the shortfall. For FY 2024, Congressman Don Davis' Community Project Funding awarded \$2,175,000 based upon a project estimate of \$2,900,000 which included 10% contingency, with the city contributing the necessary land and access easement. The award is therefore 75% of the estimated

direct cost. There was discussion on using the current 911 agreement which is 50% City and 50% County to cover the shortfall. The County’s portion would be \$362,500. Recommendation: Approve the county match of \$362,500 from fund balance and authorize staff to execute the agreement with the City of Henderson.

Retired Emergency Operations Director Brian Short appeared before the board and stated that the main purpose of the tower is for the VIPER network, not a cell phone company. The danger of having a cell phone company involved in the design is they will want to build it for their needs and not emergency responders. He cautioned the board to be careful with this and recommended the tower be built for emergency responder needs, and if there is any room left for cell phone equipment, it can be added then.

Following discussion, motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, vote unanimous, to approve the county match for the communications tower in the amount of \$362,500 from fund balance and authorize staff to execute the agreement with the City of Henderson. Further, the county will be involved in conversations related to partnerships with the tower.

Consent Agenda

Motion was made by Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the following consent agenda items as presented: June 2025 Tax Refunds and Releases, departmental monthly reports, and the minutes of the July 7, 2025 regular meeting.

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TAX OFFICE REFUND AND RELEASE REPORT FOR JULY 2025

TAXPAYER NAMCE	TAX YR	REAL		PERSONAL	SOLID WASTE FEE	REASON
M & A USA INC	2019	\$0.00		\$546.63	0	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2020	\$0.00		\$546.64	0	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2021	\$0.00		\$546.63	0	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2022	\$0.00		\$546.63	0	PERS PROP BILLED
VAYA HEALTH	2022	\$4,159.39		\$0.00	0	GOVERNMENT EXEMP
FREDERICK TERRIE	2023	\$0.00		\$42.24	120	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2023	\$0.00		\$559.60	0	PERS PROP BILLED
VAYA HEALTH	2023	\$4,159.39		\$0.00	0	GOVERNMENT EXEMP
CROMER GARY	2024	\$0.00		\$259.82	0	PERS PROP BILLED
M & A USA INC	2024	\$0.00		\$465.05	0	PERS PROP BILLED
VAYA HEALTH	2024	\$4,808.05		\$0.00	0	GOVERNMENT EXEMP
THE PEOPLES CHOICE DCAMPBELL	2025	\$0.00		\$53.66	0	CORRECT SITUS
STEVENSON JEFFREY TODD	2025	\$0.00		\$74.26	0	SITUS IN GRANVIL
TOTALS		\$13,126.83		\$ 3,641.16		

